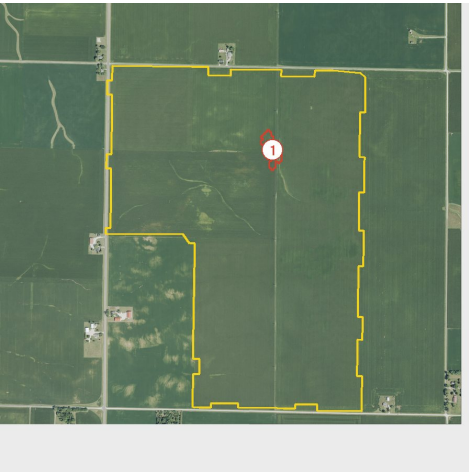


Field CHA-002

389 acres in Champaign County, Illinois. What the satellite record shows for the 2026 season.

Prepared Oct 6, 2026
Imagery through Oct 2, 2026
Field Record (working name)



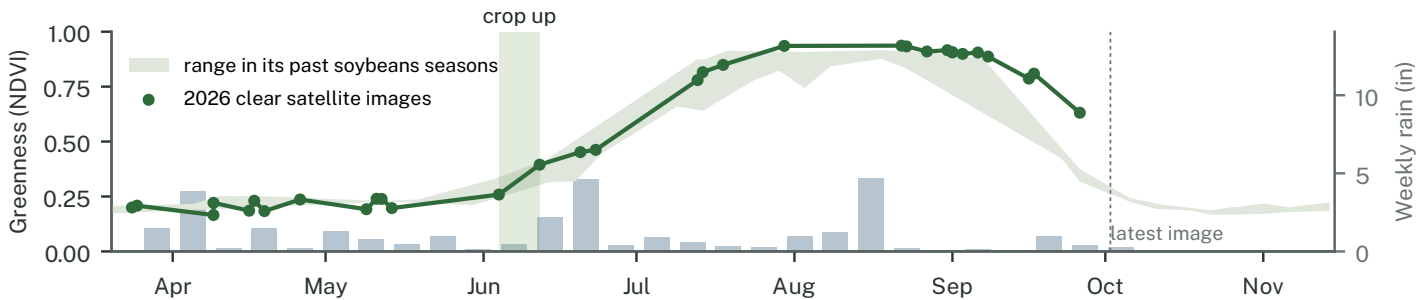
USDA NAIP aerial photo, 2023. Field boundary in yellow; numbered areas match the list below.

2026 crop	Soybeans (high confidence)
Crop came up	between Jun 4 and Jun 12, so likely planted May 21 to Jun 5
Harvest	crop still green in the last clear image (Sep 26)
After the 2025 harvest	No clear tillage pass seen
Winter 2025-26	No cover crop seen (9 clear winter images, all bare)
Season greenness	1st greenest of its 4 soybeans seasons since 2020; 8th percentile of 1,753 Champaign County soybeans fields

2019 Corn	2020 Soybeans	2021 Corn	2022 Soybeans	2023 Corn	2024 Soybeans	2025 Corn	2026 Soybeans
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Crop by year: USDA Cropland Data Layer 2019-2025; 2026 from our model.

The 2026 season

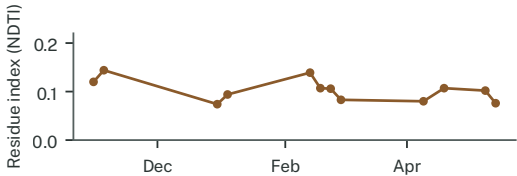


After the 2025 harvest



Oct 16, 2025, Sentinel-2 (after harvest)

Feb 28, 2026, Sentinel-2 (late winter)



Worth a look

- 2.3 acres that stay less green than the rest of the field in mid-summer (2024, 2026). Often drainage, compaction or a wet spot; worth walking.

This field is in soybeans for 2026, and the crop was up by Jun 12. Harvest has not shown up in the imagery yet; the latest clear image is from Sep 26. Through the summer it stayed behind most soybeans fields in the county (8th percentile on greenness), which tracks crop vigor but is not a yield estimate. There is 1 area worth a look on the next visit, marked on the aerial photo; the imagery shows where, not why.

Evidence. Dates above rest on these satellite scenes: Jun 4 2026, crop up (Landsat 8 path/row 023032); Jun 12 2026, crop up (Landsat 9 path/row 023032); Aug 22 2026, peak (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Sep 26 2026, dry-down, harvest (S2B T16TDK orbit 126). The chart and winter checks use 74 clear images from Aug 2025 on, all listed in the field record file.

How it was made. Greenness is NDVI and the residue index is NDTI, averaged 10 m inside the boundary (USDA NASS Crop Sequence Boundaries). Crop up is when greenness first passed 0.30; planting is estimated 1-2 weeks earlier. Hot spots use Landsat 8/9 surface temperature. Season greenness tracks crop vigor and is not a yield estimate.